

The Dance School Awards: Industry Award - Dance Teacher of the Year:

Dance Teacher of the Year Application / Nomination Questions.

Please find below 5 questions which we will need you to answer to proceed with your nomination.

Judges will consider:

- Quality and clarity of teaching practice
- Ability to motivate, inspire, and support students
- Awareness of different learning needs and pathways
- Commitment to student wellbeing and safe practice
- Evidence of professional integrity and reliability
- Ongoing professional development
- Positive impact within their school or community
- Commitment to inclusive and respectful teaching practice that supports a diverse range of students
- A clear case for why this teacher stands out this year

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Dance School Name *

Brighton College Dance School

1. What makes you an exceptional teacher? *

Amanda has transformed Brighton College into one of the country's leading dance schools, with almost 500 boys and girls now dancing through her inspirational leadership and innovative choreography. Remarkably, this success has been achieved within one of the UK's leading academic schools, where pupils balance dance with demanding academic, sporting and musical commitments. Most recently, two of Amanda's choreographed pieces were awarded first and second place at the All England Dance Regional Finals and will now compete in the National Finals.

Since becoming Director of Dance, Amanda has driven exceptional growth and standards, doubling participation, including more than 100 boys, while leading the College's strongest-ever BTEC Dance cohort. Alongside remarkable competitive success, she remains deeply committed to every pupil's wellbeing, ensuring that confidence, creativity and personal development are at the heart of everything she does.

2. How do you support and inspire your students? *

As the driving force behind the Dance department, Amanda sets a benchmark of excellence that naturally cascades through her team of visiting teachers, the pupil body, and the wider school community. Crucially, she proves that high standards and immense joy are not mutually exclusive; they are symbiotic. Pupils who dance under her guidance look back on their time at the College with immense pride, forever shaped by the sense of common purpose, rigorous teamwork, and professional-grade output she inspires. While her primary focus is dance, Amanda is a consummate collaborator. She ensures her dancers don't just develop as artists, but truly thrive as well-rounded individuals across all facets of school life.

Amanda also volunteers her time through the College's Dance in the Community programme, bringing high-quality dance education to local primary schools that would otherwise have no specialist dance provision. Through her passion and generosity, she is inspiring the next generation of young dancers and widening access to the performing arts.

3. How do you continue to develop professionally? *

Amanda is passionate about helping every pupil achieve more than they ever thought possible. She is always looking for new ways to inspire, challenge and support her dancers, continually evolving both herself and the Dance department. In a relatively short time as Director of Dance, she has transformed the school's performance culture, introducing a highly inclusive House Dance competition and reinventing our flagship Strictly Come Dancing event, giving hundreds more pupils the confidence to perform.

Committed to her own professional development, Amanda is constantly exploring new ideas, collaborating with colleagues and refining the curriculum to ensure every child can thrive. Her energy, creativity and unwavering belief in her pupils inspire everyone around her.

4. What impact have you had in the last year? *

Over the past twelve months, Amanda's choreography has earned widespread acclaim, winning major honours at the National School Dance Awards, the Royal Tunbridge Wells Dance Festival and the All England Dance Finals. Her work demonstrates remarkable artistic range, from the emotional storytelling of Message in a Bottle to the bold, visually striking Abracadabra, both praised for their originality, technical precision and creativity.

Amanda's talent also shone in the College's production of Hadestown, which received a nomination for Best Musical at the National School Theatre Awards. Working with an ensemble that included many inexperienced dancers, she inspired every performer with the confidence and skill to deliver a polished, cohesive production of exceptional quality, creating a performance that rivalled professional standards.

5. Why should you be recognised now? *

Amanda's impact as Director of Dance has been truly transformative. She has inspired unprecedented participation among both boys and girls, while raising standards to new heights and establishing one of the country's leading school dance programmes. Amanda has demonstrated that dance can thrive at the heart of a leading academic school, where pupils rehearse during the school day alongside their academic studies, sport and music.

Her success is built on exceptional teaching, inspirational leadership and an unwavering belief in every pupil's potential. Amanda has not only transformed dance at Brighton College but has also inspired colleagues across the College to think more creatively and ambitiously. She is an outstanding educator whose vision, passion and dedication make her a truly deserving recipient of this award.

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